

Project Best Practices & Guidelines

This document contains a set of best practices and guidelines to help ensure that Aging Apprentice projects are well-organized, maintainable, and successful.

GitHub Repositories vs. Projects

The Repository: The core unit on GitHub. It stores code, files, commit history, issues, and pull requests. Each repository is typically dedicated to a single codebase.

The Project: A flexible planning tool (Kanban board, table, or roadmap) for organizing work. Projects manage issues and pull requests from one or multiple repositories.

Linking Repositories to Projects

Repositories are not linked directly; instead, linkage occurs by adding individual issues or pull requests from a repository to a project.

Many-to-many relationships are supported: one project can track many repositories, and one repository can contribute to many projects.

Recommended Management Practices

1. Creating and Managing Issues

- Always open issues directly in the relevant repository to keep history tied to the code.
- Add repository issues to projects for high-level tracking.

2. Tracking Work Types

- **Labels:** Use categories like feature, bug, critical, or good first issue.
- **Views:** Create filtered project views such as Bug Queue or Feature Roadmap.
- **Custom Fields:** Use fields like Priority or Type for better sorting.

3. Labels and Milestones

- **Labels:** Set these up early. Use help wanted to signal open volunteer tasks.
- **Milestones:** Group issues into releases such as v1.0. Use milestones to indicate readiness rather than strict deadlines.

4. Setting Up a New Project

- **Layout:** Use a Board layout for Kanban-style tracking.

- **README:** Describe contribution workflow and asynchronous progress.
- **Columns:** New, To Do, In Progress, Review, Done.

My Projects

Most Aging Apprentice projects are open source and listed on the GitHub Projects page.

Project Directory

- **Woodworking:** 3D Printer Station – custom workstation for printers and accessories.
- **Machine Shop:** Nothing yet.
- **Electronics Lab:** India Table (interior lighting), Animated Christmas Tree, Candy Cane Pillars.
- **Other:** Projects and Plans (idea queue), Local Script Management.